GRC FUNDAMENTALS ASSIGNMENT

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WHAT GOVERNANCE, RISK AND COMPLIANCE MEAN TO ME

Governance is about how a company is run. It answers the questions; who makes the decisions, what rules do we follow, and who is responsible when things go wrong? When governance is strong, everybody knows their role and the rules are written down, approved, and enforced.

Risk management is about thinking ahead. Before a company makes a decision, it should ask what could go wrong, how likely is it to happen, and how bad would it be. Then it decides what to do, such as avoiding the danger, reducing it, or accepting it.

Compliance is about obeying the rules that come from outside and inside the company. These are laws, regulators' requirements, and the company's own policies. It also means being able to show proof that the rules were followed.

THREE ISSUES I OBSERVED IN THE CASE STUDY, AND WHERE EACH ISSUE BELONGS

a. No clear process for approving or enforcing company policies. This is about who has authority and who is accountable.

- **Where it belongs**: Governance
- **Reason**: This is about who has authority and who is accountable. If no one approves or enforces the rules, staff can ignore them and everybody does things their own way.

b. There is no standard way of assessing risk before making business decisions.

- **Where it belongs**: Risk Management
- **Reason**: Decisions are made without first asking what could go wrong. Problems are only discovered after the damage is done.

c. No one is responsible for tracking regulatory requirements and deadlines.

- **Where it belongs**: Compliance
- **Reason**: A financial company must meet legal duties on time. With no owner, deadlines can be missed, which may lead to fines or even losing their license.

I also noticed that the three issues are connected. The governance problem is probably the root cause, because without clear leadership and ownership, nobody feels responsible for risk or compliance either.

MY RECOMMENDATION TO IMPROVE THE COMPANY'S GRC PROGRAMME

Establish a formal governance structure by forming a GRC Steering Committee and assign every key task to a named owner.